Illia Strikhar

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347-513-7299
Remote (NYC / Berlin)

Senior Product Designer with a proven record of turning complex ideas into simple, meaningful experiences. Passionate about designing joyful, emotionally resonant products for ethical, mission-driven companies.

Skilled in end-to-end UX/UI design, strategic thinking, and building scalable design systems that drive both user delight and business growth.

Experience

Giftly — Senior Product Designer

May 2024 - Present, New York (Remote)

Lead end-to-end product design for Giftly's core consumer experience, including Home, Calendar, Events, and social gifting flows. I consolidate fragmented content into a cohesive, dynamic home experience and design multi-user event states. I partner closely with product and engineering to deliver high-quality UX from concept through implementation and contribute to the evolution of the design system.

VARIANT3D — Head of Product Design

April 2023 - August 2025, New York (Remote)

Led product design for LOOP, a web-based CAD/CAM platform for 3D-knitted products used by global apparel and footwear brands.

Owned UX/UI from 0→1, defining product vision, core workflows, and the experience from concept through closed beta. Conducted user interviews, authored interaction specs, built and scaled the design system, and led a small distributed design team. Supported closed beta rollout; LOOP was named a Top 12 Finalist in Fast Company's World Changing Ideas (2024).

Toptal — Senior Product Designer (Freelance)

September 2017 - Present, Remote

Worked with fast-scaling startups and enterprise clients across fintech, AI, e-commerce, healthcare. Specialized in data-rich UX, design systems, and go-to-market products. Some of my projects include:

- **AtriumHQ (2022-24)**: Designed core AI coaching features (Sales Coach, Goal Suggestions); helped unify the experience across product and marketing; improved onboarding and adoption
- **Seated (2020-21)**: Crafted artist dashboards + presale flows for top-tier artists (Billie Eilish, Olivia Rodrigo, Harry Styles); helped scale platform to power thousands of global tours
- **SpringML (2020)**: I designed SlowCOVIDNC and COVIDWISE, the first two official COVID-19 exposure notification apps in the US (for the North Carolina Department of Health and Human Services and the Virginia Department of Health. The apps were adopted by millions of residents, supporting large-scale exposure notifications during the early phases of the pandemic.

NiftyPM — Head of Product Design

May 2016 – September 2022, New York, NY

Founding designer for an all-in-one project management platform used by hundreds of global teams. Led UX from MVP to full launch across Web, iOS, Android, and Mac; shipped core features including tasks, roadmaps, chat, time tracking, docs, and reporting.

Education

National University of Kyiv-Mohyla Academy

MSc, Innovation Strategy & Economics

2011 - 2013

National University of Kyiv-Mohyla Academy

BA, Economic Theory

2007 - 2011

Software

Figma
Framer
Webflow
Cursor
Lovable
Github
Adobe Photoshop
Adobe Illustrator

Skills

UX Research
UI Design
Usability Testing
Heuristic Evaluation
Vibe Coding
Prototyping
Design Audit (CSS)
SCRUM / Agile

Certificates

Design-Led Strategy: Design thinking for business strategy and entrepreneurship

Issued by Coursera

Enterprise Design Thinking - Team Essentials for AI

Issued by IBM

Google UX Designer Career Certificate

Issued by Google